UX AUDIT REPORT · 2026

Arga Labs Incident Detail UI

Heuristic evaluation of the incident management interface against established UX principles, cognitive biases & design patterns

01 · AUDIT OVERVIEW

PRODUCT	CATEGORY	AUDIT DATE
Arga Labs	Incident Management SaaS	March 2, 2026
SCREEN AUDITED	**ISSUES FOUND**	**AUDIT METHOD**
Incident Detail Page	8	Heuristic Evaluation
REFERENCE STANDARDS	**AUDITED BY**	
Nielsen's 10 Heuristics, Gestalt Laws, Cognitive Bias Principles	Saasfactor · saasfactor.co	

02 · SUMMARY SCORE

60 /100

Needs Improvement

The core layout and information architecture are sound, but multiple high-severity issues create unnecessary cognitive friction and risk of user error. Most fixes are low-effort and can be shipped quickly.

4	3	1
High	Medium	Low

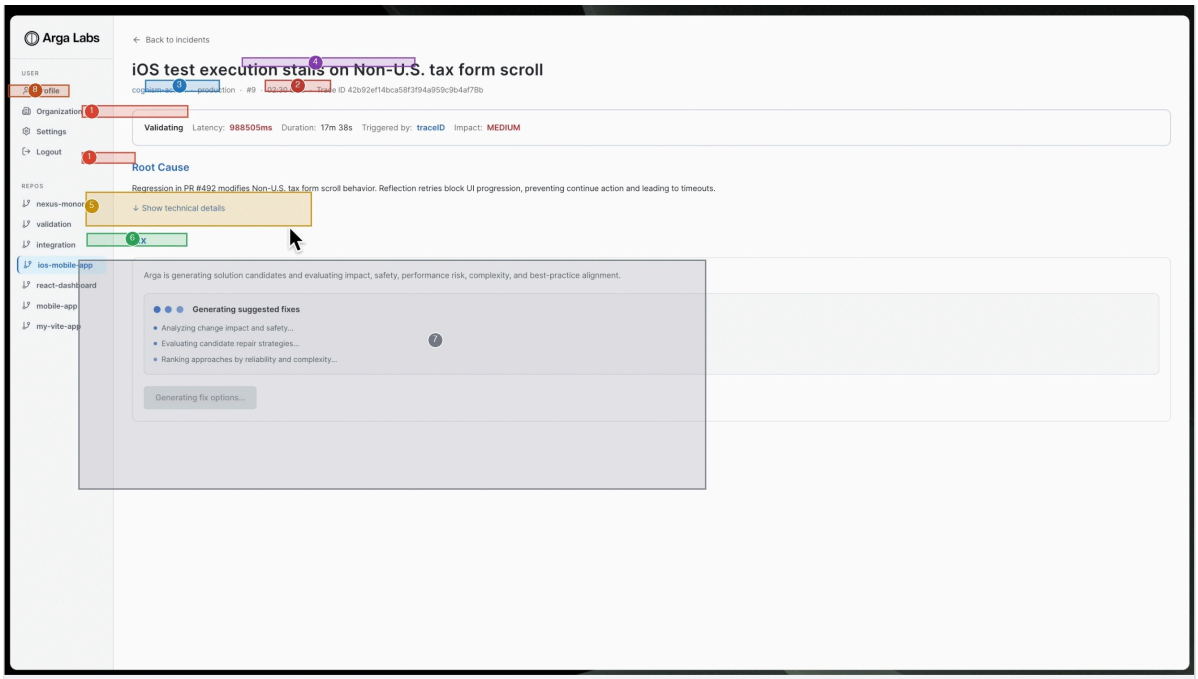
03 · ISSUES AT A GLANCE

ISSUE 02	ISSUE 03	ISSUE 05	ISSUE 06
Unformatted Duration	Plain-Text Status	Indistinct Progress Steps	Disabled Button, No Context
High	High	High	High

ISSUE 01	ISSUE 04	ISSUE 07	ISSUE 08
Non-Semantic Section Headings	Untruncated Trace ID	Empty Content Dead Zone	Destructive Action Proximity
Medium	Medium	Medium	Low

04 · ANNOTATED SCREEN

app.argalabs.io/incidents/INC-2841



Original UI with numbered issue markers · See Section 05 for detailed findings

05 · DETAILED FINDINGS

01 Non-Semantic Section Headings

Medium | Effort: Low | Visual Hierarchy

✕ CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

The "Root Cause" and "Fix" headings use the same brand blue (`#1E6BE6`) as interactive links. Users may try to click them, or fail to distinguish real links because they look identical.

✓ RECOMMENDED FIX

Change headings to **#1A1A1A** dark neutral. Reserve brand blue exclusively for interactive elements, enforcing a clear rule: **color = interactivity**.

📐 Nielsen H4 — Consistency & Standards | 🎨 Color Semantics — color should not decorate if it also signals action | 📚 Refactoring UI

02 Raw Millisecond Duration Value

High | Effort: Low | Data Readability

✕ CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Duration shows as `988505ms` — a raw integer. Users must calculate mentally to understand this is ~16 minutes. Under incident stress, this adds unnecessary cognitive load.

✓ RECOMMENDED FIX

Display **~16m 28s**. Show `988,505 ms` in a tooltip on hover. Surface useful form first; expose precision on demand.

🧠 Miller's Law — reduce cognitive arithmetic | 🔍 Progressive Disclosure — precision on demand | 📚 Practical UI — format numbers for context

03 Plain-Text Status with No Visual Encoding

High | Effort: Low | Status Communication

✕ CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Status "Validating" is unstyled body text — indistinguishable from any label. Users cannot assess incident state at a glance, especially scanning a list of many incidents.

✓ RECOMMENDED FIX

Render as a **pill badge**: colored dot + label on tinted background. Amber for "Validating", green for "Resolved", red for "Active". Pre-attentive color enables status recognition before reading.

- 👁 Pre-attentive Attributes — color before cognition
- 📡 Nielsen H1 — Visibility of System Status
- 📚 Psychology of Design — #34 Signal Detection Theory

04 Full Trace ID Hash Displayed Inline

Medium | Effort: Low | Information Density

✕ CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

The full 45-character trace ID is displayed inline. It overwhelms the scan path, adds no immediate value, and provides no way to copy it — the only action users actually need.

✓ RECOMMENDED FIX

Truncate to `42b92ef1…af78b`. Add a **copy button** that copies the full ID and shows "Copied!" for 2 seconds. Reduce noise; make the common action one click.

- ⚡ Hick's Law — reduce information load
- 🔍 Progressive Disclosure — expose complexity on demand
- 📚 Don't Make Me Think — one obvious action per row

05 Indistinguishable Progress Step States

High | Effort: Low | Process Visibility

✕ CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

All remediation steps use identical bullet markers. Completed, active, and pending steps look the same. Users cannot tell where they are or what needs attention.

✓ RECOMMENDED FIX

Three distinct states:
✓ **Completed** — green filled circle
◔ **In Progress** — spinning orange ring
○ **Pending** — empty gray circle, dimmed label

- 📡 Nielsen H1 — Visibility of System Status
- 🔵 Recognition over Recall — show state, don't require memory
- 📚 Designing User Interfaces

06 Disabled CTA Button with No Explanation

High | Effort: Medium | Action Clarity

✕ CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

"Apply Fix" is disabled with no context. Users don't know if they lack permission, a prerequisite is incomplete, or something is processing. A silent block erodes trust in the interface.

✓ RECOMMENDED FIX

Show a **progress bar** with deployment stage ("67% — index build on replica"). Make the button active, label it *"Apply Fix (67%)"*. If blocked, show: "Waiting for replica sync..."

- 📡 Nielsen H1 — Visibility of System Status
- 🚫 Nielsen H5 — Error Prevention — silent blocks confuse
- 📚 Practical UI — never disable without explanation

07 Empty Content Dead Zone

Medium | Effort: Medium | Information Architecture

✕ CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

The lower third of the screen is entirely empty. This signals an incomplete layout and causes users to lose confidence while missing key contextual information needed for resolution.

✓ RECOMMENDED FIX

Fill with an **Incident Timeline** — a chronological log of events with timestamps, actor labels, and severity icons. The most contextually relevant data for diagnosing and communicating about an incident.

📋 Information Density — empty space signals incomplete UI

🔗 Contextual Relevance — surface what users need at decision time

📚 100 Things — people read in context

08 Logout Adjacent to Primary Navigation

Low | Effort: Low | Error Prevention

✕ CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

"Log out" sits immediately next to primary nav with no separation. During fast navigation under incident stress, users risk accidentally triggering logout and losing their session at a critical moment.

✓ RECOMMENDED FIX

Move Logout to a **sidebar footer zone** separated by a horizontal rule and ≥24px gap. Spatial distance reduces accidental activation probability per Fitts's Law.

📏 Fitts's Law — spatial distance reduces mis-click risk

🚫 Nielsen H5 — Error Prevention

📚 Don't Make Me Think — isolate destructive actions

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